

battaglia di Legnano; Verdi visited Rome for its staging in January 1849. Its clear message of Italian resistance to foreign oppression was rapturously received, but the subsequent collapse of the Roman Republic temporarily dampened enthusiasm for revolution.



MARGHERITA BAREZZI

This portrait by Augusto Mussini depicts Verdi's first wife, Margherita. The couple met when Verdi lodged in the house of her father, Antonio, a wine merchant and music-lover who became Verdi's patron.